MISR LANGUAGE SCHOOLS
National Primary Stage

Grade 6

Writing



Name: _____

Class: _____

2026-2027
First Term

MISR LANGUAGE SCHOOLS
National Primary Stage

English Language Arts
Primary VI

Writing Booklet

School Year 2026/2027

First Term

Name: _____

Class : _____

Contents

Figurative Language 4
Opinion Writing 7
Introduction 8
Body 9
Closing 11
Literary Models 13
Prompt 1 Classwork 17
Prompt 1 Homework 21

Argumentative Writing 26
Introduction 27
Body 27
Closing 28
Literary Model 30
Prompt 1 Classwork 34
Prompt 1 Homework 38
Prompt 2 Classwork 46
Prompt 2 Homework 50
Prompt 3 Classwork 58
Prompt 3 Homework 62

Resources 70
Idioms 71

The Writing Process

Prewriting: thinking about a topic, brainstorming, and planning

Drafting: quickly putting thoughts on paper

Revising: reworking the organization and details

Editing: reviewing and correcting spelling, grammar, capitalization, and punctuation

Evaluating: reflecting and assessing what has been written

Publishing: sharing final writing with others

Traits of Writing

Putting it all together!

Ideas
are the main message.
Choose an interesting topic. Focus on what matters to you.

Organization
is the structure of the piece.
Include a beginning, middle, and ending.

Voice
is the person behind the words.
Make your writing sound like you. Show that you care about the topic.

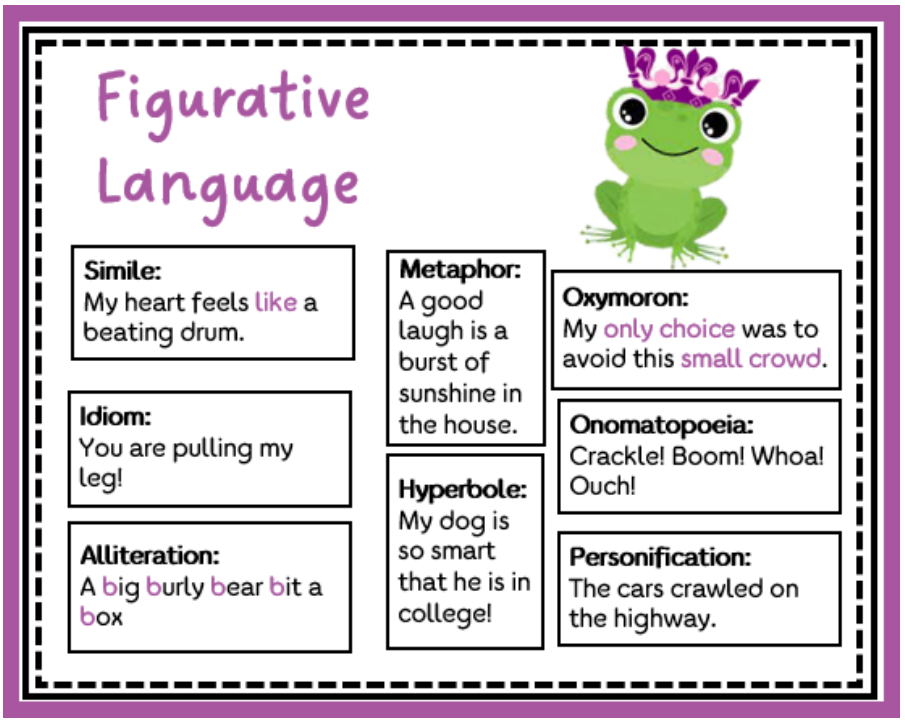
Word Choice
is the use of rich language.
Use precise language. Choose specific nouns and active verbs.

Sentence Fluency
is the structure and flow of sentences.
Make your writing smooth and easy to read aloud.

Conventions
are the rules that guide readers toward meaning.
Check spelling, capitalization, punctuation, and grammar.



Presentation
is how the writing looks on the page.
Make the overall appearance pleasing to the eye.



Figurative Language

Figurative language is words used in creative ways to ignite the readers' imagination. The words used do not necessarily have direct meanings.

Examples of Figurative language:

- **Alliteration:** Repeated beginning consonant sounds.
  Ex: **P**eter **P**iper **p**icked a **p**eck of **p**ickled **p**eppers.
- **Idioms:** Phrases that have different meanings from their individual parts.
  Ex: Amanda spilled the beans. She told her mom everything!
- **Onomatopoeia:** Words that sound like their meanings.
  Ex: Splash! Zap! Poof! OMG! Wham!
- **Simile:** When two different objects are compared using as or like.
  Ex: Adam bolted **like** a frightened rabbit.
- **Metaphor:** When two different objects are compared **without** using as or like.
  Ex: The sun is a gleaming pearl.
- **Personification:** Non-human objects given human characteristics.
  Ex: The candle flame danced in the wind.
- **Oxymoron:** Two opposite or contrasting words put together to create a funny or dramatic effect.
  Ex: jumbo shrimp, seriously funny, deafening silence

- **Hyperbole:** An extreme exaggeration used to make a point or create a strong impression.
  Ex: I'm so tired I could sleep for a year.
  I've told you a million times!

A. <u>Directions: Read each sentence and answer the question</u>.

1. The moon peeked through the clouds.
   What type of figurative language is used?
   a. metaphor b. personification c. hyperbole d. simile

2. Rewrite the sentence using a simile:

   The moon was bright.
   _____

3. The kids dropped the dishes. They smashed on the floor and shattered into pieces.
   a. idiom b. oxymoron c. onomatopoeia d. metaphor

4. Complete the sentence with a suitable oxymoron.
   The library was filled with a _____.

5. Rewrite the sentence using a hyperbole.

   I was tired after the game.
   _____

6. The busy bees buzzed beside the bushes.
   What type of figurative language is used?
   a. alliteration b. simile c. metaphor d. idiom

7. Complete the idiom:
   When Tom forgot his lines on stage, he had to _____ and continue.

8. Write your own sentence using personification.
   _____

B. <u>Directions: Rewrite each sentence to include the figurative language in brackets</u>.

1. The rain fell heavily. (personification)
   _____
2. The boy ran quickly. (simile)
   _____
3. The classroom was very noisy. (onomatopoeia)
   _____
4. The old tree was strong. (metaphor)
   _____
5. The girl was extremely nervous. (hyperbole)
   _____
6. The cat moved quietly. (alliteration)
   _____
7. The room was strangely quiet. (oxymoron)
   _____
8. The secret was revealed. (idiom)
   _____



Nonfiction Essays

Discussion **Opinion** **Argumentative**

There are three main types of nonfiction essays. The first type is a discussion essay. The second type is an opinion essay, which is the focus of this lesson. The third type is the argumentative essay.

An **opinion essay** is a semi-formal piece of writing where you share what you think about a topic. You're not just sharing your opinion; you're trying to persuade the reader to agree with you by providing strong reasons, elaborations (explanations), and examples.

An opinion essay should have a word count of 200-250 words. It should include:

A catchy **title** that clearly portrays your opinion

Introduction:

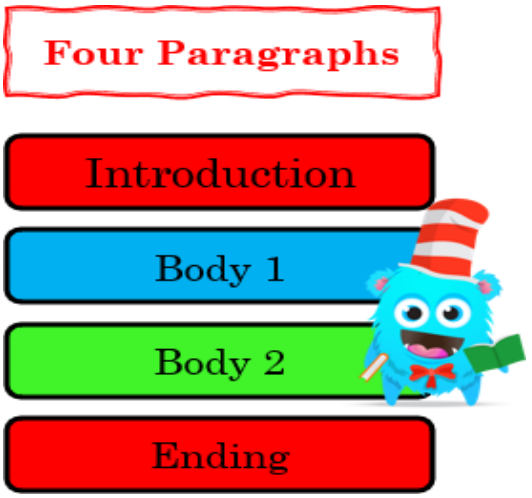
- **General** statement: Introduces the topic
- **Thesis or opinion** statement: Clearly states what you believe

Body Paragraphs:

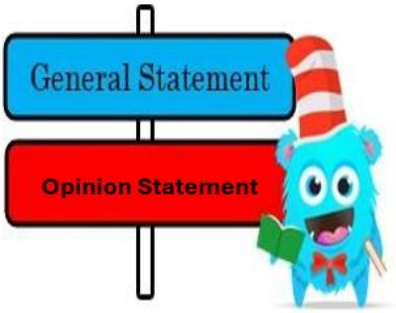
- **Reasons:** Facts that support your opinion
- Elaborated **explanation** and **examples**: Explain your reasons clearly and support them with examples

Conclusion:

- Restate your **opinion** and leave the reader with a final thought or question.
- Use two idioms and strong adjectival phrases to help you pass your message across.







The introduction consists of two sentences. A general statement that presents the topic, and a thesis statement that firmly and clearly presents what you believe.

Make sure to choose a strong title that reflects your opinion.

<u>Example</u>: School trips are organized outings where students visit places such as museums, parks, and other sites. From my perspective, school trips are a valuable component of the learning process.

Note: Don't forget to add an opinion transition word before stating your opinion.

Use one of the following transition words to state your opinion.

Opinion Transition Words

- **I believe**
- **I strongly believe/ think**
- **From my perspective**
- **You may think…, but I'm here to tell you…**



The body of an opinion article provides facts with explanations and examples to persuade the reader to agree with you. It is formed of two body paragraphs. Each body paragraph presents one strong reason followed by a lot of elaboration in the form of detailed explanation and examples to make the argument clear and convincing.

Body 1

This paragraph contains the following:

- A topic sentence
- The first reason, clearly stated
- Elaboration: detailed explanation
- Examples that clarify the presented reason

Body 2

This paragraph contains the following:

- The second reason, clearly stated
- Elaboration: detailed explanation
- Examples that clarify the second presented reason

Remember to use:

- use reason transition words
- elaboration and examples transition words
- idioms and adjectival phrases
- strong verbs and adjectives
- factual evidence
- estimations
- analysis

Reason Transition Words

- To begin with
- A key reason why…
- Another important reason is that…
- Moreover
- Furthermore

Elaboration Transition Words

- To elaborate
- To illustration
- In other words
- Simply put
- This also means

Examples Transition Words

- For instance
- For example
- This also matters because
- In other words
- This shows that
- Moreover
- Furthermore



This paragraph concludes the essay by restating the writer's opinion clearly to support the reasons explained in the body.

It also offers a strong and convincing final thought by putting the matter in the reader's hands or adding a rhetorical question that leaves the reader thinking about what they should do or believe.

The ending paragraph must:

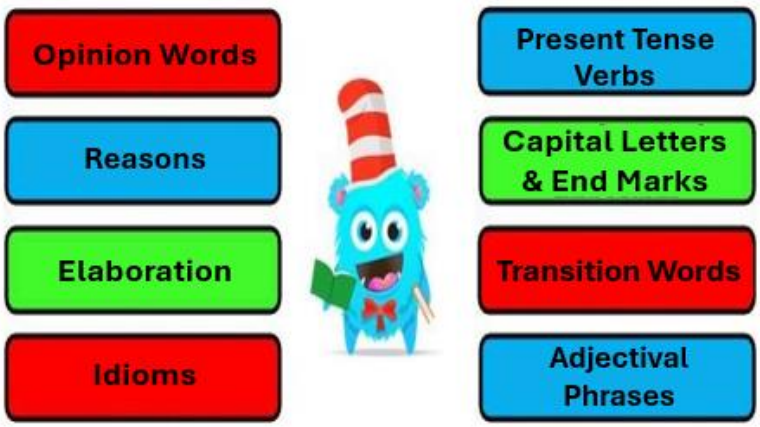
- Restate your thesis in a new way
- End with a strong final sentence:
  - ✓ ask a rhetorical question
  - ✓ Put the matter in the reader's hands.

Example: **All in all, going to school every day helps students stay healthy and focused. What are you waiting for? Let's make the change today!**

Ending Transitions

- **All in all**
- **To sum up**
- **In conclusion**
- **As can be seen**
- **The ball is in your court**

Remember to use:



Transitional Words and Phrases

Opinion	• I believe • I strongly believe/ think • In my perspective • You may think….. but I'm here to tell you
Reason	• To begin with • A key reason is • Another important reason is • Moreover • Furthermore
Elaboration	• This shows that • In other words • To elaborate • To illustrate • Simply put • Namely
Examples	• For example • For instance • This also matters because • In other words • This shows that • Moreover • Furthermore
Ending	• All in all • To sum up • In conclusion • As can be seen • The ball is in your court

Quick Tips



Make sure your title clearly shows your opinion.



Be clear about your opinion from the start.



Use transitional words and phrases to connect your ideas.



Elaborate with real-life examples to explain each reason.



End with a question or challenge to make your reader think!

Prompt: Should kids be required to wear a school uniform? State your views.

WITH Opinion Writing Graphic Organizer

Introduction

General Statement: School uniforms have been a part of many educational systems for years, and they continue to be a topic of discussion.

Thesis Statement: Students should be required to wear school uniforms

Body

Body 1

1st reason: promote equality and reduce social pressure

Elaboration:

- Elaboration and examples

Example:

Body 2

2nd reason: help students focus on their studies

Elaboration:

- Elaboration and examples

Example:

Ending

Restate thesis: Uniforms encourage equality and improve concentration

Rhetorical question: Isn't it time to get dressed for learning instead of competition?

Dress for Success

(Title must clearly reflect which side you are on)

School uniforms have been a part of many educational systems for years, and they continue to be a topic of discussion. **From my perspective,** students should definitely be required to wear school uniforms because they promote equality and help students focus on learning for several reasons.

To begin with, uniforms promote equality and reduce social pressure. **To illustrate**, they level the playing field where students are judged by their character rather than their clothing. **For example**, students from families with different incomes can fit in without worrying about expensive brands. **Furthermore,** students who wear uniforms don't get bullied due to fashion choices, which allows everyone to feel like they are on the same team.

Moreover, uniforms help students focus on their studies. **To explain,** students can keep their eyes on the ball and concentrate on what really matters. **For instance,** students do not waste time deciding what to wear every morning, making it easier to arrive at school prepared. **In addition**, uniforms reduce classroom distractions, helping learners put their best foot forward and participate more effectively in lessons.

To conclude, requiring students to wear school uniforms is a smart decision because it encourages equality and improves concentration. Isn't it time to get dressed for learning instead of competition?

AGAINST

Opinion Writing Graphic Organizer

Introduction

General Statement: School uniforms are common in many schools around the world, but not all students agree with this policy.

Thesis Statement: Students shouldn't be required to wear school uniforms.

Body

Body 1

1st reason: limit personal expression

Elaboration: - Elaboration + examples

Example:

Body 2

2nd reason: financial burden

Elaboration: Elaboration + examples + idioms

Example:

Ending

Restate thesis: Uniforms reduce individuality and create unnecessary expenses.

Rhetorical question: Shouldn't schools celebrate diversity instead of covering it up?

Uniforms Are Not the Answer

(Title must clearly reflect which side you are on)

School uniforms are common in many schools around the world, but not all students agree with this policy. **From my perspective**, students should not be required to wear school uniforms because they limit self-expression and place an unnecessary financial burden on families.

To begin with, uniforms take away personal expression. **To elaborate,** students should have the freedom to show their personalities through their appearance. **For example**, some children enjoy wearing clothes that reflect their hobbies and interests. **Furthermore,** others like to wear colors and styles that represent their culture or individuality. Being forced to wear the same outfit every day can feel like walking in someone else's shoes.

In addition, uniforms can be a financial burden. **To clarify,** parents may have to spend extra money on special clothing that can only be worn at school. **For instance,** some schools require custom-made uniforms that cost an arm and a leg. **Moreover,** children grow quickly, so families often need to replace uniforms several times a year. Since money does not grow on trees, these costs can put a strain on families' income.

To sum up, school uniforms should not be mandatory because they reduce individuality and create unnecessary expenses for families. Shouldn't schools celebrate diversity instead of covering it up?

Date: _____

Classwork

Prompt: Should children receive an allowance for helping with household chores? State your views**.**

Vocabulary Bank	
With	Against
responsibility development enjoyment opportunity progress	pressure stress risk limitation

Idioms	
With	Against
- a blessing in disguise - pay off in the long run - make the most of	- a pain in the neck - bite off more than you can chew - push yourself too hard

Adjectival Phrases and Expressions	
With	Against
- confidence-boosting - life-enhancing - positive and encouraging	- stress-inducing - frustrating and tiring - not worth the effort -time-consuming

Opinion Writing Graphic Organizer

Introduction

General Statement:

Thesis Statement:

Body

Body 1

1st reason:

Elaboration:

Example:

Body 2

2nd reason:

Elaboration:

Example:

Ending

Restate thesis:

Rhetorical question:

Draft

Date: _____

Group Work

Prompt: Should families take vacations together every year? State your views.

Vocabulary Bank	
With	Against
responsibility development enjoyment opportunity progress	pressure stress risk limitation

Idioms	
With	Against
- a blessing in disguise - pay off in the long run - make the most of	- a pain in the neck - bite off more than you can chew - push yourself too hard

Adjectival Phrases and Expressions	
With	Against
- confidence-boosting - life-enhancing - positive and encouraging	- stress-inducing - frustrating and tiring - not worth the effort -time-consuming

Opinion Writing Graphic Organizer

Introduction

General Statement:

Thesis Statement:

Body

Body 1

1st reason:

Elaboration:

Example:

Body 2

2nd reason:

Elaboration:

Example:

Ending

Restate thesis:

Rhetorical question:

Draft

Opinion Essay Checklist

Layout and Organization

- ☐ I wrote 4 paragraphs
- ☐ I used transition words to connect my ideas
- ☐ Each paragraph has one clear focus

Opinion Structure

- ☐ My introduction has a strong general statement and a clear opinion
- ☐ I used two strong reasons to support my opinion
- ☐ Each reason is elaborated
- ☐ Each reason is supported by examples
- ☐ The ending restates my opinion in a new way

Word Choice & Transition Words

- ☐ I used opinion words like I think, In my perspective
- ☐ I used transition linkers like: To begin with, Moreover
- ☐ I included a final thought, a rhetorical question, or a challenge for the reader (The ball is in your court)

Voice & Style

- ☐ My writing sounds confident and persuasive
- ☐ I used complete sentences and stayed on topic
- ☐ The introduction and the ending show how I strongly feel about the topic
- ☐ The body paragraphs are voiceless and state facts

Editing & Revising

- ☐ I reread my essay to check if it makes sense
- ☐ I checked for punctuation and capitalization mistakes
- ☐ I corrected any spelling or grammar mistakes I found
- ☐ I used my best handwriting



What Is an Argumentative Essay?

An argumentative essay, otherwise known as a “pros and cons” essay, is a piece of writing that investigates a certain topic and generates a balanced and objective analysis of both sides of an issue supported by evidence and facts.

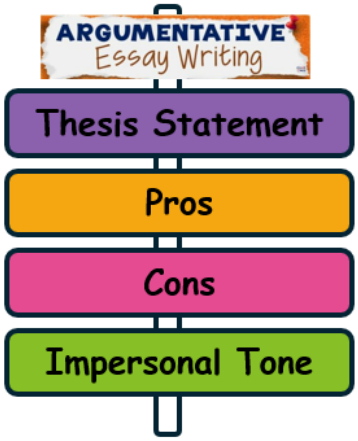
The facts are presented **neutrally** without taking sides, covering the most important arguments for and against.

“For and against" essays are normally written in a **semi-formal**, **impersonal** style.

Argumentative essays are organized into **four paragraphs**.

An argumentative essay should have a word count of 200-250 words.

Parts of an argumentative essay:



✎ **Introduction:** (1 paragraph)

① **must include:**

☐ General Statement

☐ Thesis statement

✎ **Body:** (2 paragraphs)

② **Body 1:** Pros

③ **Body 2:** Cons

✎ **Closing**: (1 paragraph)

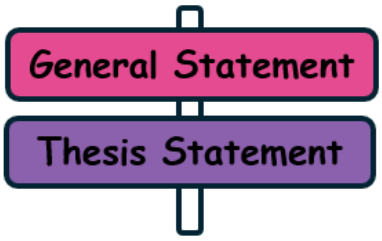
④ **restates the thesis statement and ends with a strong closing**

Pros = in favor of the topic

Cons = against the topic

Introduction

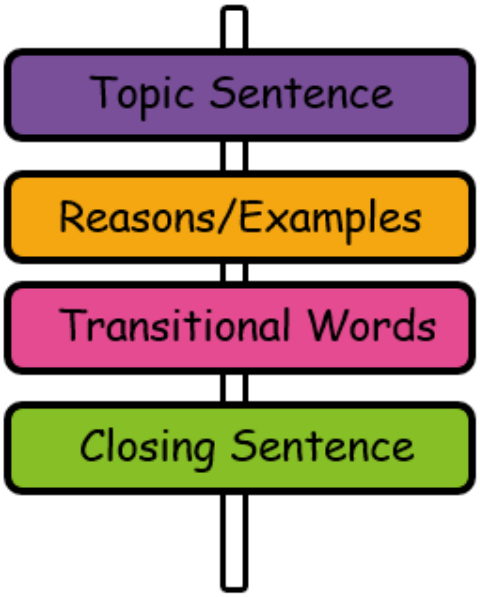
The introduction to your argumentative essay should engage your readers. It starts with a strong **general statement** that attracts your reader's attention to the given topic, while staying neutral, followed by your **thesis statement**.



Body

The body consists of <u>two</u> paragraphs. The first paragraph includes the **pros** of a topic. The second paragraph includes the **cons** of the same topic.

Each paragraph begins with a topic sentence, followed by supporting details and examples to reinforce the presented reasons, and ends with a closing sentence.



<u>Note</u>: Use some transition words to make a natural transition to the topic. It makes the writing sound logical for readers to follow.



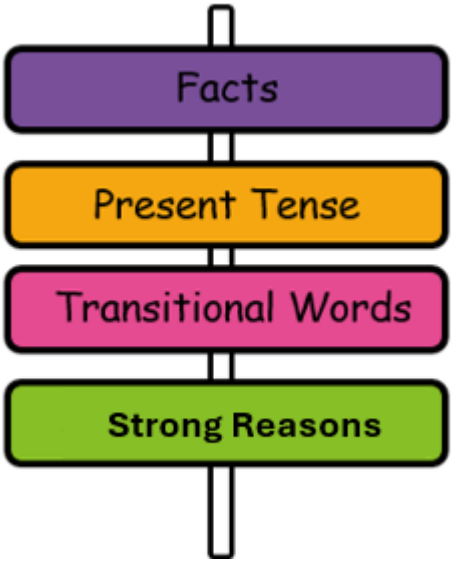
The closing paragraph consists of two elements: restating the thesis and a call for action.

Restating the thesis means repeating the thesis using different words. The tone is neutral and informal throughout the essay, except for the closing.



The last part is **a call for action** by putting the matter in the reader's hands to make their own decision.

Note: The essay is made up of 4 paragraphs using the following:



Transitions when providing the pros and cons:

- First
- To start
- To begin with
- Second
- Next
- Another reason
- Finally
- Lastly
- Most importantly
- One last reason

Transitions when elaborating:

- To elaborate
- To illustrate
- Simply put
- In other words
- This means
- Namely

Transitions when providing examples/ details:

- For example
- For instance
- In particular
- Specifically
- Additionally
- In other words
- In fact
- An example is

Transitions when presenting the cons:

- By contrast
- On one hand
- On the contrary
- In comparison
- Alternatively
- On the other hand
- Another way of viewing this
- Another alternative is

Transitions when concluding:

- In conclusion
- As you can see
- As has been noted
- Given these points
- To sum it up
- All things considered
- In the final analysis
- As can be seen

More expressions:

benefits and drawbacks// pluses and minuses// pros and cons// merits and demerits // benefits and hindrances// highlights and challenges// opponents and proponents// upside and downside

Steps for Writing an Argumentative Essay

Once presented with a topic:

- think/research about arguments/ counterarguments
- Choose the strongest ideas.
- Use the ideas to fill in the graphic organizer before writing your draft.

Literary Model

Write about the advantages and disadvantages of online examinations.

Vocabulary Bank	
With	Against
progression atmosphere innovations	sticklers contagious technical difficulties

Idioms	
With	Against
- at the click of a button - opens the door to	- bring _____ to a halt

Adjectival Phrases and Expressions	
With	Against
-**younger, tech-savvy** generations - **tense, stressful exam** atmosphere	- **serious technical** difficulties

Million-Dollar Words List
tech-savvy, administering, efficient, recovering from an illness, technical difficulties, halt, tense, stressful exam atmosphere, disrupt

Introduction

① General Statement In today's world, younger, tech-savvy generations are increasingly exposed to online examinations.	Thesis Statement Advantages and disadvantages of online exams

Body Paragraph 1: Pros

② Topic Sentence: several benefits

Reason complete with a click of a button	Elaboration complete from any location
Example take exams from home when sick	Closing sentence improve accessibility and convenience

Body Paragraph 2: Cons

③ Topic Sentence: numerous drawbacks

Reason technical difficulties	Elaboration internet failure, system errors
Example weak internet connection halts the exam	Closing sentence technical problems disrupt online exams

Closing

④ Restate Thesis
online exams reflect convenience but create challenges

Call for action
The ball is in your court. What would be your choice?

A Double-Edged Sword

In today's world, younger, tech-savvy generations are increasingly exposed to online examinations. This debatable topic has both advantages and disadvantages that must be carefully examined.

On one hand, online exams can be completed at the click of a button, making assessment more efficient and accessible. In other words, students are no longer required to travel to an exam hall or sit in a tense, stressful exam atmosphere, as they can complete their assessments from any location. For example, a student recovering from an illness can take an exam from home without missing it. Overall, this shows how online exams improve accessibility and convenience.

On the other hand, serious technical difficulties may occur. To illustrate, issues such as internet failure or system errors can suddenly interrupt the exam and affect performance. Specifically, a weak connection may bring the exam to a halt and cause students to lose answers. To sum up, this highlights how technical problems can seriously disrupt online assessments.

In conclusion, although online exams reflect educational progression and convenience, they also create serious challenges. The ball is in your court. Would you undergo online exams?

Directions: Answer the following questions.

1. a. What is this essay mostly about?

_____

b. Is the title biased, or is it neutral? Why?

_____

_____

2. a. Circle the hook and underline the thesis.
b. What is mentioned in the thesis?

_____

3. How many body paragraphs are there? _____

4. What does the first body paragraph discuss?

_____

5. Write the sentence that shows how the first advantage was further explained.

_____

_____

6. What does the second body paragraph discuss?

_____

8. Write the sentence that shows how the first disadvantage was further explained.

_____

9. Draw a box around the transition words used.

10. What is written in the closing paragraph?

_____

_____

Date: _____

Classwork

Prompt 1: Some schools provide extracurricular activities like music, drama, or sports clubs for students after school hours. Write about the advantages and disadvantages of participating in such activities.

Pros	Cons
- boost students' skills and confidence - play a vital role in improving students' well-being	- can be time-consuming - may lead to students pushing themselves too hard

Vocabulary Bank	
With	Against
boost reduce proponents	expense opponents

Idioms	
With	Against
- give it your all - play a vital role -benefits outweigh drawbacks	push (oneself) too hard drawbacks outweigh benefits

Adjectival Phrases and Expressions	
With	Against
health-boosting highly competitive	time-consuming physical exhaustion

Million-Dollar Words List	
Introduction	
① General Statement	Thesis Statement

Body Paragraph 1: Pros

② Topic Sentence:	
Reason	Elaboration
Example	Closing sentence

Body Paragraph 2: Cons

③ Topic Sentence:	
Reason	Elaboration
Example	Closing sentence

Closing

④ Restate Thesis
Call for action

Draft

Date: _____

Homework

Prompt 1: Many people support students' participation in sports during the scholastic year, whereas others believe that academic work should be the main focus. Discuss both sides of the argument.

Pros	Cons
- Improves physical and athletic skills - Builds discipline and positive habits	- reduces time for rest and hobbies - Can affect schoolwork and balance

Vocabulary Bank	
With	Against
boost reduce proponents	expense opponents

Idioms	
With	Against
- give it your all - play a vital role -benefits outweigh drawbacks	push (oneself) too hard drawbacks outweigh benefits

Adjectival Phrases and Expressions	
With	Against
health-boosting highly competitive	time-consuming physical exhaustion

Million-Dollar Words List	
Introduction	
① General Statement	Thesis Statement

Body Paragraph 1: Pros

② Topic Sentence:	
Reason	Elaboration
Example	Closing sentence

Body Paragraph 2: Cons

③ Topic Sentence:	
Reason	Elaboration
Example	Closing sentence

Closing

④ Restate Thesis
Call for action

Draft

Comments:

Ideas & Content	**/8**
Organization	**/4**
Sentence Fluency	**/4**
Conventions	**/4**
Total	**/20**

Argumentative Writing Checklist

An introduction paragraph that includes:

- ☐ a hook
- ☐ a thesis statement about the topic

2 body paragraphs

- First body paragraph includes:

☐ a topic sentence
☐ 2 reasons
☐ 2 illustrations and examples
☐ a closing sentence

- Second body paragraph includes:

☐ a topic sentence
☐ 2 reasons
☐ 2 illustrations and examples
☐ a closing sentence

The closing paragraph includes:

☐ a restated thesis statement
☐ my opinion using an opinion transition word
☐ a call for action

☐ I used present tense verbs
☐ I used strong reasons and examples
☐ I used transition words

Argumentative Writing Rubric

	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Ideas & Content ✍ *Central Idea* ✍ *supporting details* ✍ personality ✍ sense of audience	• Exceptionally clear central idea, with strongsupporting detail • Clear topic sentence • Strong details in the body • Restates the thesis • Clear viewpoint with a consistent, engaging style throughout (arguments on each side of the debate are clearly stated) • Vocabulary and expression are relevant to the topic • Strong sense of audience **(7-8 Marks)**	• Evident central idea with some supporting details which may be general • Clear topic sentence • Some details in the body • Restates the thesis • Viewpoint is somewhat clear but not consistent (arguments on each side are too general and vague) • Good choice of vocabulary for the purpose • Inconsistent personality **(5-6 Marks)**	• Central idea isconfusing • Topic sentence is related but not strong. • Few details in thebody • Does not restate thesis • Arguments are not supported by clear evidence • Few and simple vocabulary used • Voice may be inappropriate or non-existent **(3-4 Marks)**	• Lacks central idea • Topic sentence is unclear • No details in thebody • Does not restate thesis • Some elements of the text type can be seen • Basic vocabulary words used **(1-2 Marks)**
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Sentence Fluency & Punctuation ✍question, exclamation, command, statement	• Has a variety of sentences that flow • Uses punctuation marks accurately • Capitalization is correct (**3-4 Marks)**	• Has a variety of sentences • Some punctuation is used correctly • Most capitalization is correct (**2-3 Marks)**	• Sentences are all the same • Fragments and run-ons are used • Few capital letters used **(1-2 Marks)**	• All sentences are run-ons and fragments • Lack of punctuation • Lack of capital letters **(0-1 Mark)**
Conventions ✍age-appropriate, spelling, caps, punctuation, grammar	• Accurate use of grammar **(2 Marks)** • Accurate spelling (**2 Marks)**	• 1-3 grammar errors **(1 Mark)** • 1-3 spelling errors (**1 Mark)**	• Numerous errors in grammar and spelling that make it difficult to read (**0 Mark)**	

Rewrite

Date: _____

Classwork

Prompt 2: Some people believe that family gatherings bring many benefits, while others think they can create challenges. Discuss both sides of the argument.

You may use the following ideas:

Pros	Cons
- create memories and strengthen family bonds - allow people to show appreciation to one another	- can be stressful and exhausting - can create pressure and financial burden

Vocabulary Bank	
Pros	Cons
- create memories - bonding - show appreciation -festivities - meaningful	- pressure to impress - exclusion - obligation - exhaustion - materialism

Idioms	
Pros	Cons
-count your blessings - owe someone a debt of gratitude	- costs an arm and a leg - a pain in the neck

Adjectival Phrases and Expressions	
Pros	Cons
- joy-inducing -feel valued - relationship-strengthening	- stress-inducing - time-consuming

Million-Dollar Words List	
Introduction	
① General Statement	Thesis Statement

Body Paragraph 1: Pros

② Topic Sentence:	
Reason	Elaboration
Example	Closing sentence

Body Paragraph 2: Cons

③ Topic Sentence:	
Reason	Elaboration
Example	Closing sentence

Closing

④ Restate Thesis
Call for action

Draft

Date: _____

Homework

Prompt 2: Some people support celebrating birthdays every year, while others think such celebrations are not worthwhile. Explain both viewpoints.

You may use the following ideas:

Pros	Cons
- Strengthens emotional bonds - creates joyful memories and positive feelings	- Causes financial and social pressure - Encourages materialism and unrealistic expectations

Vocabulary Bank	
Pros	Cons
- create memories - bonding - show appreciation -festivities - meaningful	- pressure to impress - exclusion - obligation - exhaustion - materialism

Idioms	
Pros	Cons
-count your blessings - owe someone a debt of gratitude	- costs an arm and a leg - a pain in the neck

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Comments

Ideas & Content	**/8**
Organization	**/4**
Sentence Fluency	**/4**
Conventions	**/4**
Total	**/20**

Argumentative Writing Checklist

An introduction paragraph that includes:

☐ a hook
☐ a thesis statement about the topic

2 body paragraphs

- First body paragraph includes:

☐ a topic sentence
☐ 2 reasons
☐ 2 illustrations and examples
☐ a closing sentence

- Second body paragraph includes:

☐ a topic sentence
☐ 2 reasons
☐ 2 illustrations and examples
☐ a closing sentence

The closing paragraph includes:

☐ a restated thesis statement
☐ my opinion using an opinion transition word
☐ a call for action

☐ I used present tense verbs
☐ I used strong reasons and examples
☐ I used transition words

Argumentative Writing Rubric

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Ideas & Content ✍ *Central Idea* ✍ *supporting details* ✍ personality ✍ sense of audience	• Exceptionally clear central idea, with strongsupporting detail • Clear topic sentence • Strong details in the body • Restates the thesis • Clear viewpoint with a consistent, engaging style throughout (arguments on each side of the debate are clearly stated) • Vocabulary and expression are relevant to the topic • Strong sense of audience **(7-8 Marks)**	• Evident central idea with some supporting details which may be general • Clear topic sentence • Some details in the body • Restates the thesis • Viewpoint is somewhat clear but not consistent (arguments on each side are too general and vague) • Good choice of vocabulary for the purpose • Inconsistent personality **(5-6 Marks)**	• Central idea isconfusing • Topic sentence is related but not strong. • Few details in thebody • Does not restate thesis • Arguments are not supported by clear evidence • Few and simple vocabulary used • Voice may be inappropriate or non-existent **(3-4 Marks)**	• Lacks central idea • Topic sentence is unclear • No details in thebody • Does not restate thesis • Some elements of the text type can be seen • Basic vocabulary words used **(1-2 Marks)**
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Rewrite

Date: _____

Classwork

Prompt 3: Some people believe that social media has many benefits, while others think it causes harm. Discuss both views.

You may use the following ideas:

Pros	Cons
- Improves thinking and problem-solving skills - Provides entertainment and social connection	- causes health and focus problems - Can affect behavior and school performance

Vocabulary Bank	
Pros	Cons
moderation encourage creativity achievement	addiction aggression frustration

Idioms	
Pros	Cons
- a great way to unwind - sharpen your mind	- get carried away - on a slippery slope

Adjectival Phrases and Expressions	
Pros	Cons
- problem-solving skills -enhancing hand-eye coordination - develop quick thinking	- social isolation -emotionally draining -physically sedentary

Million-Dollar Words List	
Introduction	
① General Statement	Thesis Statement

Body Paragraph 1: Pros

② Topic Sentence:	
Reason	Elaboration
Example	Closing sentence

Body Paragraph 2: Cons

③ Topic Sentence:	
Reason	Elaboration
Example	Closing sentence

Closing

④ Restate Thesis
Call for action

Draft

Date: _____

Homework

Prompt 3: Some people argue that playing video games helps develop useful skills, whereas others believe that it can negatively affect students' lives. Discuss both sides of the argument.

You may use the following ideas:

Pros	Cons
- Improves thinking and problem-solving skills - Provides entertainment and social connection	- causes health and focus problems - Can affect behavior and school performance

Vocabulary Bank	
Pros	Cons
moderation encourage creativity achievement	addiction aggression frustration

Idioms	
Pros	Cons
- a great way to unwind - sharpen your mind	- get carried away - on a slippery slope

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Comments:

Ideas & Content	**/8**
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☐ a restated thesis statement
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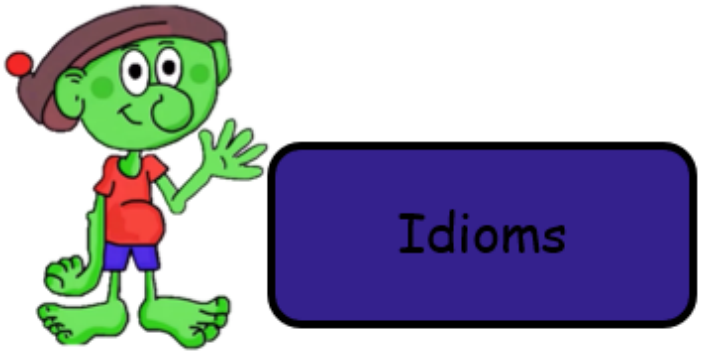
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☐ I used strong reasons and examples
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Rewrite


RESOURCES



Idiom	Meaning
a hard nut to crack	a difficult person to deal with
better late than never	It is better to do something late than not to do it at all.
break the ice	To become friends with somebody or start something with them.
bread and butter	A person's earnings for daily expenses
break a leg	good luck, best wishes
chasing rainbows	chasing something impossible to achieve
costs an arm and a leg	when something is very expensive
cool as a cucumber	someone who is very calm and relaxed
draw a longbow	to lie or exaggerate
easier said than done	when something is tougher to do than you thought it would be
feeling under the weather	to feel sick
find your feet	to be confident or familiar with something
beat around the bush	to avoid getting to the actual point
your guess is as good as mine	I don't know
hit the sack	go to sleep
left out in the cold	to be ignored
boil the ocean	take up an impossible project
a chip off the old block/ apples don't fall far from the tree	someone who acts or behaves like his parents
every cloud has a silver lining	all bad things lead to good things eventually

down for the count	to quit or give up
give it a whirl	to give something a try
go the extra mile	to put in some extra effort
step up your game	to start doing something better
has bigger fish to fry	having more important work to do
Getting to learn all these idioms will be **a piece of cake**!	



